

Ryan Cates

Web Designer & Design Engineer

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I design in the medium. Thirteen years designing marketing sites, landing pages, and campaigns, the last eight owning the web at Pendo. I make layout, type, and motion decisions in the browser and ship them, directing AI coding agents so the time saved on building goes into the finish.

EXPERIENCE

Pendo · Raleigh, NC

Lead Marketing Engineer (Design Engineer)	Sep 2022 – Present
Senior Marketing Engineer	Aug 2020 – Aug 2022
Marketing Engineer	Jun 2018 – Aug 2020

SELECTED WORK

- **Pendo for Agents (Sep 2026).** Sole designer and builder of a three-page launch, from Content and PMM's narrative to live in a month. Extended the homepage system into a new design language with WebGL color fields, art-directed product-UI motifs, and a demo drawer one click from every section. Weekly demo requests rose about 40% after the launch campaign.
- **pendo.io homepage (Aug 2026).** Designed and built the homepage around Content and PMM's story, launched in six languages. Headless Pendo, an interactive demo of Pendo inside AI tools that grew out of my concept-car prototypes, drew about 59% of tracked section interactions; sales asked for clips of it within a day.
- Built a review toolbar into the live homepage so leadership could compare copy and design variants in the real page and share them by link, which moved alignment earlier and reduced rework.
- **Novus (Mar – Aug 2026).** Built the agency-designed launch site for novus.ai pixel-perfect in under a week for the Pendomonium reveal, using a frame-first, block-by-block AI workflow. Then partnered with Novus's head of product to turn their Claude Design concept into the current site with my own design direction. Now leading Novus web.
- **Same craft, new floor (Jun 2026).** A self-initiated campaign for Pendo's AI products, from idea to a scroll-driven landing page in one evening, with copy by Claude. Presented to corporate marketing; it didn't run, for reasons outside my control.
- Reskinned core product pages in about five weeks for Pendomonium 2026, then shipped a filterable live changelog within a day of a C-suite request (shown at a company-wide town hall).
- Owned the Pendomonium event site year over year: Lottie and motion design, plus a custom admin for 80+ sessions.

SYSTEMS, ENABLEMENT, AND CONVERSION

- Shipped ~30 reusable Builder.io components in the move to Next.js, so marketers build premium pages themselves.
- Coached non-technical marketers to ship with Builder Fusion: 25 PRs opened and 19 merged, including a registration page that set APAC records.
- First marketing engineer to adopt Cursor agents; share prompts, rules, and boilerplates across the team.
- Led development of Product Benchmarks, an interactive data tool built on Pendo usage data: \$345K sourced and \$8.2M influenced pipeline, used in closed deals, and adopted into Pendo's product roadmap.
- Redesigned the self-guided tours hub on my own initiative, fixing a confusing entry point to a key demand driver.

Oracle + Bronto

Senior Web Designer	Sep 2014 – Mar 2018
- Owned design for most Bronto web properties: landing pages, email, banner ads, video, and animation, end to end.	

Earlier

- **Yellow House Graphic Design** · Graphic Designer, Web Developer (2013 – 2014): brand, web, print, and WordPress themes for agency clients. **Freelance** · Web Designer, chemicalprobes.org (2016 – 2017).

INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

- **Lintel** (lintel.design): a visual bento-layout builder with tokenized spacing that exports clean Tailwind HTML, standalone HTML, or React JSX.

RECOGNITION

Hone Your Craft Award (2026) and Marketing Collaboration Award (2022) at Pendo; top rating in the last three review cycles

EDUCATION

A.A.S., Graphic Design The Art Institute of Raleigh-Durham

SKILLS

Design: web and landing page design, layout, typography, grid, hierarchy, interaction and motion design, prototyping, design systems and tokens, conversion-focused UX
Tools: Figma (incl. Dev Mode), Adobe CC, Lottie, Builder.io
Front-end: HTML, CSS, Tailwind, JavaScript / TypeScript, React, Next.js, GSAP, WebGL, Vercel
AI: Cursor agents, Claude, ChatGPT, Builder Fusion, MCP